

Section B: Exploring poetry and Shakespeare (02)

Text choice	Content	Learners should be able to:
Shakespeare Choice of one play from: • <i>Romeo and Juliet</i> • <i>The Merchant of Venice</i> • <i>Macbeth</i> • <i>Much Ado About Nothing</i>. Where an extract is printed on the question paper it will be taken from the <i>The Complete Works of William Shakespeare: The Alexander Text</i> (Collins Classics). Centres are free to use any edition of their chosen Shakespeare text but should avoid using heavily edited editions.	Centres study one set text from a choice of four Shakespeare plays. Learners develop comprehension skills. Learners articulate their understanding of aspects of plot, characterisation, events and settings and to distinguish between literal and implied meaning. Learners develop critical reading skills, learners engage personally with texts clearly written for performance and build confidence in their abilities to sustain an individual response which is supported and justified. Learners reflect on relevant social, historical or cultural contexts – for example, social customs and attitudes. Learners develop their own viewpoints supported by textual evidence, whilst at the same time recognising that there are different interpretations that other readers could make.	reflect critically and evaluatively on their reading. Learners are expected to respond to some of the following: • themes, ideas and issues • atmosphere and emotion • plot development • characters and relationships • language • dramatic effects • relevant social, historical or cultural contexts as demonstrated in the play. • pay attention to the details of a text: understanding the significance of a word, phrase or sentence in context • demonstrate the ability to read at a literal level and also explore deeper implications • explain motivation, sequence of events and the relationship between actions or events. • identify and interpret key themes • make an informed personal response, justifying a point of view by referring closely to evidence in the text • reflect critically and evaluatively on a text, using an understanding of context to inform reading • recognise and evaluate the possibility of different valid responses to a text.